

FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION
Office of Administrative Law Judges

IMPACT PRODUCTS, LLC AND SAFETY ZONE, LLC,
Complainants

v.

LIHUA LOGISTICS COMPANY LIMITED - LLHP, *Respondent*.

DOCKET NO. 24-06

Served: March 8, 2024

ORDER OF: Alex M. CHINTELLA, *Administrative Law Judge*.

ORDER EXTENDING TIME TO FILE ANSWER

On March 8, 2024, Respondent filed a motion seeking an extension of time to file its answer from March 11, 2024 to April 10, 2024. Respondent's counsel represented that he was retained on March 5, 2024 and will need additional time to obtain documentation related to Complainant's claims as the documentation relates to "more than 100 invoices" and is "located overseas." Complainant consents to the extension.

I will grant the motion on the basis that counsel needs additional time to become familiar with the case and prepare the answer, but I caution Respondent: cases before the Commission routinely involve hundreds of transactions and parties or witnesses in foreign countries. In the era of electronically stored information and instantaneous communication, these rationales will not serve as a sufficient basis to extend the discovery phase of this proceeding. I encourage Respondent to plan for document discovery accordingly.

The motion is **GRANTED**; Respondent must file its answer by **April 10, 2024**. All other requirements of the Initial Order remain in effect.

ALEX CHINTELLA

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ALEX CHINTELLA
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Alex M. Chintella
Administrative Law Judge